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The principles of congruency and of alternating generations are both conditionally negated by the fact that Ego has joking relationships both with his cross-cousins and with their parents. The G/wi explanation of this situation is ingenious and throws some light on their perception of their own social structures. In the vernacular model the ideals of band exogamy and virilocality combine to locate cross-cousins in bands other than one's own. Interaction with them is, therefore, infrequent, and the problem of incongruent triangles seldom arises. Cross-cousins of opposite sex are preferred marriage partners. Clearly one cannot marry all of them, but the parents of the one taken as a wife immediately cease to be joking relatives, *babama* and *mamasa*, and become *ba:/wima* (father-in-law) and *gje:/wisa* (mother-in-law), who are in the avoidance category. The remaining cross-cousins, according to the G/wi explanation, will be separated from their parents by marriage, ruling out incongruous triads. There are, therefore, two mutually exclusive forms of interaction possible, either of which solves the problem of awkwardness that is inherent in incongruent triangles.

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However, endogamy is common in large bands and cross-cousins are, in fact, brought together in such bands. Informants did not verbalize the cognitive calculus that solved this problem, but the practice is for those cross-cousins who are impossible or unlikely marriage partners (being already married or of inappropriate ages) to treat one another as siblings and their respective parents as "little" (or classificatory) parents. The transformation is not carried through to the generation of the parents themselves, so their own joking/avoidance balance is not disturbed by the change. Such ad hoc distortion of formal structure is typical of G/wi social organization and will be discussed later at greater length.

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A system of categorization that selects a large proportion of a universe for inclusion has two possible organizational strategies. First, it may contain a large enough number of specialized, narrow categories, each with distinctive criteria of qualification, to be able to accommodate every possible member selected from the population universe. Alternatively, the system may have a limited number of specialist categories but must, then, have one or more broad categories into which can be placed any residual members not qualified for specialist classification. The G/wi kinship system, in its extension of kindreds, is based on the second strategy, having a few narrow, specialized categories and a small number of broad, unspecialized categories. In contrast to the numerous categories of the first strategy, in which qualification criteria are necessarily exhaustive, 148

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Kinship Terminology

Table 7. Breadth of kinship term categories

Kinship term	Person to whom term may be applied
<i>ba:ma</i>	F, MH (the two are distinct in instances of remarriage after divorce or widowing)
<i>gje:sa</i>	m, fw (the two are distinct in cases of polygyny or remarriage)
<i>ba:g/wāma</i>	FB, FFBS, FFFBSS, MFBS, MMFBS, MFFBSS, H, of <i>gje:g/wasa</i>
<i>gje:g/wāsa</i>	mz, mmzd, mmmzdd, fmzd, ffmzdd, fmmzdd, w, of any <i>ba:g/wama</i>
<i>babama</i>	MB, MMBS, MMMBSS, FMBS, FFMBS, FMMBS, H, of any <i>ma:sa</i>
<i>ma:sa.</i>	fz, ffzd, fffzdd, mfzd, mmfzdd, mmffzdd, w, of any <i>babama</i>
<i>gjibaxuma, gijaxuma</i>	B, FBS, MZS, FFBSS, MMZSS, FWS
<i>gjibaxusa, gijaxusa</i>	z, mzd, fbd, fbbdd, mmzdd, mhd
<i>n//odima</i>	SS, DS, ZS, MZDS, FBDS, son of any <i>babama</i> / <i>ma:sa</i> , H of any <i>n//odisa</i>
<i>n//odisa</i>	dd, sd, zd, mzdd, fbbdd, d, of any <i>babama</i> / <i>ma:sa</i> , w of any <i>n//odima</i>
<i>g/wāma</i>	S, DH, BS, "BS," WS, HS, S, of any <i>n//odima</i> / <i>n//odisa</i>
<i>g/wāsa</i>	d, sw, bd, "bd," wd, hd, d, of any <i>n//odima</i> / <i>n//odisa</i>

the criteria for qualification in the broad categories are few and tend to be nondistinctive. A large measure of versatility is permitted. Individuals may vary their categorization with changes of the social context and field of interaction, and in the same category one member may readily be substituted for another. Table 7 illustrates the breadth of the terminological categories.

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